

14. Source: Meeting with representatives of the local guards and their family

****Report: Meeting with Local Guard Representatives****

The director of the hospital facilitated a meeting between the Health for All delegation and representatives of the local guards at a townhouse close to the hospital. Within the meeting room were several women dressed in mourning black. These women were introduced as the widows of the guards who lost their lives protecting the hospital amidst the violence over the past three years.

It was pointed out that without the bravery and sacrifice of the local guards, Health for All wouldn't have been able to function in the district. With Health for All's recent announcement of leaving the country, concerns were raised about how the widows are expected to sustain themselves without due compensation. Drawing a parallel, the representatives inquired about the protocols in Switzerland for the survival of families when their sole breadwinner passes away, expecting similar measures to be taken here.

The delegation expressed their condolences to the widows and assured the guard representatives of their genuine intention to address the situation. However, they emphasized that it's challenging to address these concerns while their international staff are confined in residences. The local guards clarified that Health for All's sudden decision to depart from the city and the country director's abrupt leave without meeting tribal leaders or the local administration precipitated this crisis.

Acknowledging the oversight, the delegation, who came directly from Switzerland, expressed their eagerness to rectify the situation. They sought the support of the guard representatives in facilitating the safe release of the detained international staff. This would pave the way for the hospital's operations to resume in the near term and devise longer-term solutions. In response to the widows' compensation claims, the delegation committed to liaising with their headquarters to seek resolutions.

The guard representatives deferred the decision regarding the staff's release to the tribal leaders. They emphasized the importance of Health for All recognizing the distress and unfairness their decision to leave has inflicted upon the community. The shared goal is to find a solution, ensuring the hospital's operations are restored.